

Allgo with \$50 tablet

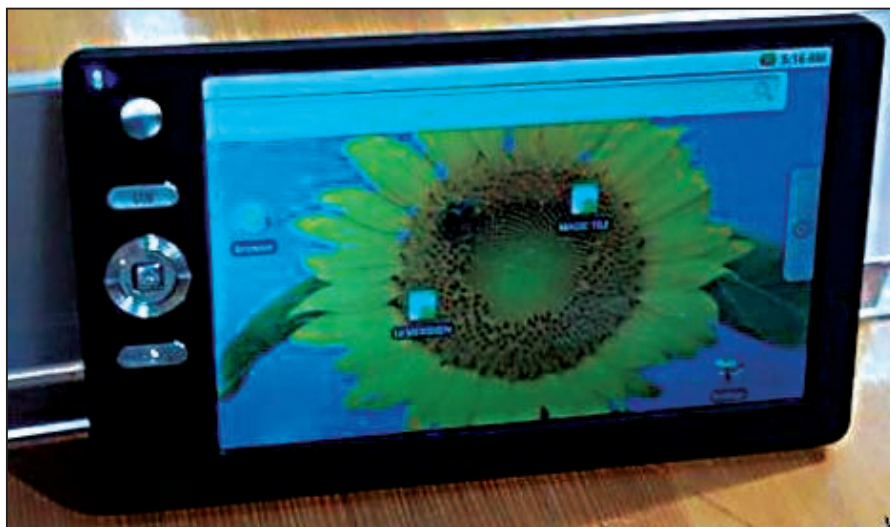
With the \$35 tablet making news globally, there's mention of a \$50 tablet by Indian company Allgo

Dell Streak in Asia?

The Dell Streak is expected to have an Asia launch early next year

India's \$35 tablet shown off

After the Nano, India was again the centre of attention. This time for the cheapest tablet



India's \$35 tablet PC made another rare public appearance on August 11th.

Apart from being eye-candy, it also had some of its specifications laid bare – and they certainly seem juicy: 2GB RAM, 3G and Wi-Fi connectivity, SIM card slot, microSD expandable storage, video out, microUSB, web cam, and as is evident, the Android 2.1 OS. The tablet was introduced to the Indian public by Kapil Sibal, the Human Resource Development Minister, who also said it is only expected to release by mid-2011, looking to put 1 million units in the hands of students and educational institutions by government order, subsidised to around \$35 each.

While the total cost of production is still not known, the value of all the parts is estimated to be around \$50. So while the \$35 dream may never come to pass, at

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least on the retail side, the effort and even a \$100 price tag are very commendable. To make it energy efficient, the whole unit is powered by a 2-watt power supply, suitable for even the rural areas of India.

It is expected to be available in three screen size variants: 5-inch, 7-inch, and 9-inch. The hosts of an Indian tech show were pleasantly surprised at the tablet's capabilities, and called it a "fairly impressive package" that ran the Android OS smoothly, while noting that the touch-screen was not very responsive.

In related news, Nicolas Negroponte and OLPC (One Laptop per Child)'s have announced they expect to sell 1 million XO laptops in India by the end of 2010. Previous attempts at selling its low cost laptops (called XO-1) to the masses were not very successful, despite Intel's Classmate PC's growing success. Negroponte recently pledged "free and open access" to his company's laptop technology to help further India's \$35 tablet dream in an open letter to an Indian daily. The letter also contained some friendly but

preachy advice from Negroponte, such as a word of caution to Minister Kapil Sibal not to treat MIT's and OLPC's supposed \$100 laptop (retailing in India for approximately \$300) as competition, instead, as an example to be learnt from, in as many words: Your tablet is not an "answer" or "competitor" to OLPC's XO laptop. It is a member of a family dedicated to creating peace and prosperity through the transformation of education. In closing, I repeat my offer: full access to all of our technology, cost free. I urge you to send a team to MIT and OLPC at your earliest convenience so we can share our results with you.

Now Sanjay Jha, the Country Head of OLPC India, has announced that OLPC intends to sell 1 million of the Rs. 15,000-priced laptops in India by the end of 2010. **d**



Union Minister Kapil Sibal unveiling the \$35 tablet